```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<head>
  <title>My page.</title>
</head>
<body></body>
```

... but it is better practice to explicitly include the opening/closing `<html>...</html>` tags. Where the tags are omitted, the root `html` element is implicit: the data structure that the client builds from this HTML will include a root `html` element. In addition, an `html` element must include `head` and `body` child elements, and the `head` element must have a non-empty `title` child element, which will control the title of the page and is usually shown in the web browser as the name of the tab containing the page. A `head` element will typically also contain many other elements that are treated as document metadata. The `body` element can be empty and still be valid, though the client is going to render a fairly pointless empty page. The `body` element contains all the content that you wish to be displayed to the user.

Some History...

The HTML doctype declaration is a blunt instrument; it simply tells the client, "this is HTML." In the really, really olden days (when I was still a young person), HTML documents were typically written in a couple of ways, one version for Netscape Navigator (RIP) and one for MS Internet Explorer (aka Exploder, also RIP). Then along came the W3C (World Wide Web Consortium) standards, which were great but introduced a problem: they broke most sites on the internet at the time. The two browsers in question began to offer different rendering modes, one that adhered to the new standards ("standards mode") and one that did not ("quirks mode"), and the doctype declaration was used to switch between the two.

In "quirks mode," browsers behaved like Navigator 4 and Internet Explorer 5... told you this was ancient history! `<!DOCTYPE html>` is simply an instruction to the browser to render in modern "standards mode," and I'm fairly certain you will never have to worry about quirks because you are reading this in 2025 (or later). Also consigned to the bin of history is XHTML (which is HTML written to conform to XML syntax rules). XHTML was an attempt to enforce some (arguably unnecessary) rigor to HTML but in practice it made generating pages much more difficult. An XHTML document has the `Content-Type: application/xhtml+xml` header, which browsers will use to go automatically